

Agreeing and Disagreeing 2

A Quick-Reference Guide

Polite disagreement: Suggesting a change to a plan, or a different idea

1. Be polite by being positive:	2. You should:
1. Focus on positive details, don't say anything negative. 2. Avoid conflict, disagreement, argument, bad feelings. 3. Keep relations affirmative (friendly, warm, good, happy). 4. Be flexible.	a) Soften your comment. b) Connect to the idea of the other person. c) Praise (say something good about) the other idea.

Other Person:	You:
1. I think we should change the temperature in here. Let's make it 35 degrees.	Changing the temperature is a good idea, how about 25 degrees instead. - That's an idea. What do you think about 25 degrees? - That's a good idea. Could we make that 25 degrees?
2. Let's advertise your secret idea!	Great...I hope that in the future you can help us publicize the idea, but for now we should probably keep it quiet while it is still a secret and being patented.
3. Let's have another meeting at 11pm tomorrow.	(C,B) Another meeting tomorrow, that's a good idea. (A) <u>How about</u> 7pm? And (A) <u>what do you think of</u> having the meeting at a place where we could get something to drink?

Softening Phrases		
How about... What do you think of... Maybe...	I think... We could try... Perhaps...	One idea might be... Could we (make that)... How's this...

Agreeing to an invitation or request	Responding to offers
E.g. Request Q: "Please give me a fish cake." Formal - Waiters or waitresses will say: - excellent choice - certainly - absolutely - <i>positively</i> - ok - sounds great Informal phrases: - no problem - sure - right - not a problem - gotcha - got it	E.g. Offer Q: "Let's have lunch tomorrow": - Ok, (sure.) - sure(ly) - certainly - sounds great - absolutely - If it wouldn't be any trouble. - I would love to. + (add on) - Thank you very much. - What time? (How about 11:30. or How does 11:30 sound) - Where shall we go?